The 4 Garhwal defences were located just ahead of Bridge 3 at Nuranang. Two companies, Alpha and Delta, were deployed to dominate the winding road that came up from Jang. Sheer cliffs on either side of the valley protected their flanks that could not be bypassed. Beyond the forward positions, the village of Jang lay some 4,000 feet below. From well sited observation posts, most of the Tawang Chu Valley was visible, while across the river they could clearly observe the forward slopes of Geyshe-la, Rho, Sheo and Lao villages. A little to the left, on the Bum-la slopes, Tawang and its impressive monastery situated on a spur were clearly visible.

The presence of 2 Derajat Mountain Battery's 3.7 howitzers increased the offensive power of the forward defences of 4 Garhwal. This was later further beefed up with the deployment of 25-pounder guns two kilometres behind the forward positions. A company of 4 Sikh LI and a platoon from 13 Dogra had also been deployed for a while with 4 Garhwal and this had helped develop a fine rapport between the men. Most importantly, extremely energetic junior officers were commanding the forward companies. Their enthusiasm and aggressive spirit had communicated itself to the men who were now itching to have a crack at the Chinese.

On 16 November, a group of Monpas appeared near the leading company of 4 Garhwal Rifles. Second Lieutenant Surinder Nath Tandon who was commanding Alpha Company asked Subedar Udai Singh Rawat commanding the forward platoon to investigate. The JCO had got to within thirty metres of the group when he realized they were Chinese soldiers carrying weapons concealed under their Monpa robes. Keeping his wits about him, the JCO threw a grenade at the party and scrambled back into the defences.

This little charade having failed, early next morning the Chinese launched their attack on No. 2 Platoon of Alpha Company that was positioned on the forward right side of the company's defences. This platoon was alerted to the presence of the Chinese when anti-personnel mines around the defences started going off all around them. Chinese mortars opened up briefly, after which they started to attack in waves. For thirty minutes the Chinese tried to close the gap with the three platoons of Alpha Company but the Garhwal troops held their own, shooting down the Chinese with deadly accuracy. The Chinese then pulled back to their forming-up area, to reorganize for a second attack.